Beneath Quiet Streets

written by

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SHERIFF'S PHONE

Deputy texts

DEPUTY REED
Sheriff, there's been another one. Max Alden, a Property Acquisition Agent for the facility, was found dead in his room, the Penthouse at the hotel. Cleaning staff found him this morning.

SHERIFF
Cause of death?

DEPUTY REED
Autopsy is yet to confirm, but there appears to be blunt trauma to the head.

SHERIFF
Just what we need. People have been getting nervous enough already. The facility might even think they need to get involved now.

DEPUTY REED
I think they're right to be nervous. There's been too many now to call it all a coincidence.

SHERIFF
A string of bad luck doesn't make accidents into murders. Let's follow procedure and hope no one starts interfering in our work.

DEPUTY REED
Yes, Sheriff.

SHERIFF'S PHONE

Deputy texts - date unknown

SHERIFF
We got an outside investigator coming in. Despite my best assurances to the Mayor that we've got things handled, the recent volume of unsolved cases spooked him.

(MORE)

SHERIFF (CONT'D)
He went over my head to the Attorney General, who pulled some strings and now we've got a big-city detective coming in next week.

DEPUTY REED
I think we could use the help.

SHERIFF
The only thing we need help with is showing the Mayor his fears are baseless and this whole situation is just a collection of run-of-the-mill coincidences. But keep up the crime scenes for now, we'll need the detective to have a look at them before they're cleaned up.

DEPUTY REED
Yes, Sheriff.

SHERIFF'S PHONE

Deputy texts

DEPUTY REED
Just letting you know the autopsy reports are ready for review at the hospital morgue for the last two cases.

SHERIFF
Thanks, I'll review them with the detective when he arrives.

DEPUTY REED
I wrote up a report on the missing persons investigations in case you wanted to bring those up to the detective too, put it on your desk.

SHERIFF
You're still on about that? I'm not wasting the detective's time. It's just more people wandering into the woods without enough water, happens every year.

DEPUTY REED
Not this many! And all these suspicious deaths which frankly look like homicides to me happening at the same time? What if we have a serial killer on our hands?

SHERIFF
There's nothing suspicious about a few accidents. You'll learn when you've had a bit more experience under your belt. All this detective will do is prove that you and the Mayor are panicking over nothing.

DEPUTY REED
Yes, Sheriff.

SHERIFF
And don't think I don't know about all this investigation you're doing behind my back. I ought to have you fired for insubordination.

DEPUTY REED
I really believe something's not right here, Sheriff.

SHERIFF
Sometimes your gut is wrong, son. Believe me, I know. You can't go chasing every flight of fancy, you've got to be rational. You'll learn soon.

SHERIFF'S PHONE

Deputy texts - date unknown

DEPUTY REED
Sheriff, I think I've got a major lead. I'm near a drainage pipe to the south of the facility, can you meet me here?

SHERIFF
I told you to wait at the office! If you never obey my orders, at least obey them when this outsider is in town! The last thing we need is him writing up our department for insubordination.
(MORE)

SHERIFF (CONT'D)
I've let you stay on against my better judgement because I saw a good cop in you, and now you go and pull something like this?

SHERIFF'S PHONE

Text from Unknown, recent.

UNKNOWN
I saw someone - maybe a young woman? - bury something in the wheat field the night Max Alden died. Starting from the front door of the diner in the direction of the streetlight, about 22 steps forward, 17 steps left. I thought it might just be some farm work at first, but it hasn't sat right with me. Just occurred to me I should let you know.

SHERIFF'S PHONE

Notes:

SHERIFF
Sandra seems off tonight. Usually she bright and cheery, but tonight she seems unnerved, especially around me. I hope that poor girl didn't get herself into trouble.